



GDD 28

Reality Check

Real, staged, faked or false?

The media-literacy game for ages 12-15, at full teen strength. A fast "spot it" game where teens learn to tell real from staged, faked or false, see how the feed is curated and manipulated, and, where a school enables it, get an honest, strictly non-explicit reality check on how media and pornography portray love and sex. Critical, calm, never explicit. Eight mechanics, 17 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Real, staged, faked or false?

Today's teenager lives in a feed where almost nothing is quite what it seems: ads disguised as posts, influencers' "perfect" lives, staged outrage, AI fakes and deepfakes, and a constant stream of half-true forwards. Reality Check trains the single most useful modern skill, telling real from staged, faked or false, through fast "spot it" rounds. It also does what most media-literacy games avoid: an honest, age-appropriate, strictly non-explicit reality check on how media and (where a school enables it) pornography portray love, bodies and sex. The goal is a teen who questions what they see and can't be easily fooled. New v2 build, the teen peak of the media thread.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g28 · reality-check (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / critical / calm
Thread / topics	G · Values, Rights & Media · UNESCO 5.1, 5.2, 5.4, 4.3, 5.5, 2.1, 2.3
Prerequisite / builds on	builds on g16 (Crossroads), g12 & g17 · sets up g36 (Decoded)
Gating	Gated the media-and-sexuality module sits behind the school-comfort toggle
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the media-literacy game.

85
scenarios

8
mechanics

15
myth-flips

17
choice & voice

0%
binary taps

Gated & disableable. The "Love, romance & sex on screen" module is controlled by the school-comfort toggle and can be fully turned off, leaving the rich media-literacy core intact. Where enabled, it is strictly non-explicit: it teaches literacy about media and never shows or describes any content. Curiosity is treated as normal and never shamed.

The feed they live in.

From the Chapter 4 personas. Teens scroll for hours through a feed engineered to persuade and compare; many have already met fakes, scams and pornography. This game hands them the lens to read all of it, and the routes to get help.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Riya, 15	To stop measuring herself against curated, edited perfection.	swipe + reflect: it's a highlight reel.
Veer, 14	An honest, non-shaming reality check that porn isn't real, and not to forward fakes.	strike-rewrite + branch: performance, not life.
The Counsellor	To route fakes, scams and exposure to real help.	role-play + match: report & support.
Every teen	Four quick questions that make them hard to fool.	spot + branch: think for yourself.

Why this works (the evidence). Feeds are curated, constructed highlight reels, and naming the specific manipulations (disguised ads, influencer perfection, clickbait, misinformation, deepfakes) is what stops them working. Media, and pornography where covered, portrays love, bodies and sex unrealistically; with roughly 93% of boys and 62% of girls exposed to pornography before 18, an honest, non-explicit reality check beats silence. And because AI fakes now defeat simple "tells", the durable skill is to verify the source before believing or sharing.

Eight moves, led by "spot it".

It's a decoding game, so **spot** and **swipe** lead, fast "is this real, staged or fake?" rounds, with **strike-rewrite** flipping the media myths. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
spot (decode) <i>signature</i>	Reads a post or scene to spot the trick, edit or tell.	Seeing the curation.	16
strike-rewrite	Flips a media myth ("if it's online it's real"; "porn is real sex").	Conceptual change.	15
swipe (real vs reel)	Snap-judges real vs staged, ad vs organic, trust vs check.	Fast discrimination.	13
branch (decide)	Chooses what to do with a fake, a scam, a demand, a spiral.	Judgement; safety.	11
reflect	Considers comparison, curiosity and the four questions.	Self-application.	10
sort	Sorts ad vs organic; reliable vs manipulation; real vs fantasy.	Spot the line.	10
role-play (voice)	Reassures a friend; flags a problem to a trusted adult.	Voice; support.	6
match	Pairs a trick to its tell; a problem to its helpline.	Connections.	4

17 of 85 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%** (swipe is a rich real/reel judgment, not a yes/no tap).

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Reality Check plays on the genuine pleasure of seeing behind the curtain. A post looks real, you swipe, and the reveal pulls it apart, the ring light just out of frame, the 40th retake, the "#ad" hidden at the bottom. The "how the trick works" breakdowns are satisfying, the "spot it" rounds have a quick, clever rhythm, and the AI-fake reveals are genuinely eye-opening. It feels less like a lesson and more like becoming impossible to con.

Is it teaching?

Yes: that feeds are curated and constructed; the specific manipulations and their tells; that media and pornography portray love, bodies and sex unrealistically (porn is staged performance, not real sex, not a relationship model, not sex education); that AI fakes are real and the answer is to verify the source; that non-consensual and child imagery is illegal; and exactly how to report and get help.

The belief it moves. From "if it's online it's real; everyone's life is better than mine; porn shows real sex; you can always spot a fake; nothing can be done about it" → "the feed is a curated, manipulable highlight reel; screen sex is a performance; verify the source; and fakes can be reported and removed."

Built, not bolted on.

85 researched scenarios across the real-vs-reel → manipulation → media/sex → fakes & rights → help → think-for-yourself arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Real vs reel	15	swipe, spot, reflect	Feeds are curated highlight reels; the comparison trap.
The manipulation files	16	spot, sort, match	Disguised ads, influencer perfection, clickbait, misinfo, deepfakes.
Love, romance & sex on screen (gated)	15	strike-rewrite, sort, reflect	Unrealistic romance; porn is performance, not real, not sex-ed. Non-explicit.
Fakes & your rights	13	branch, strike-rewrite, match	Verify the source; non-consensual/child imagery is illegal.
Find help, report, protect	12	branch, role-play, match	cybercrime.gov.in / 1930, Childline 1098, a trusted adult.
Think for yourself	14	reflect, spot, branch	The four critical questions, applied to anything.

A real-vs-reel swipe + the "spot a fake" flip, verbatim.

swipe: "A friend's flawless 'just woke up like this' selfie"
left "Real & unedited" right "Posed & filtered" answer -> right

flip: "You can always spot a deepfake by the weird hands."
UN -> "You can always spot a deepfake, just look for weird hands."
RE -> "Fakes keep improving and visual 'tells' often fail; verify the source instead."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 28 Reality Check — Scenario Library.json](#) (85 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
If it's online, it's real.	A feed is a curated, constructed highlight reel, not reality.	Media literacy.
Everyone's life is better than mine, look at their feeds.	You're comparing your behind-the-scenes to their highlight reel.	Comparison.
Films and songs show what real love is like.	They show a dramatic fantasy script; real love is two-way and ordinary too.	Media & relationships.
Pornography shows what real sex is like.	It's staged performance by paid actors, not real sex.	Porn literacy.
Porn is a good way to learn about sex.	It isn't sex education; it shows little real consent, communication or care.	Porn literacy.
You can always spot a deepfake by the weird hands.	Tells often fail now; verify the source instead.	Deepfakes 2026.
Making a fake nude of someone is just a prank.	It's harmful and illegal; a fake of a minor is child sexual abuse material.	NCII / POCSO.
I'm too smart to ever be fooled online.	Anyone can be fooled; habits and the four questions are the protection, not ego.	Humility.

The micro-loop.

1. **Drop.** Sam drops a post, image, ad or claim into the feed.
2. **Judge.** The teen calls it, real, staged, faked or false, and checks (swipe/spot).
3. **Reveal.** UN busts "if it's online it's real"; RE shows exactly how the trick worked.
4. **Decide.** On a fake, scam or demand, the teen picks a safe move (branch): verify, don't forward, report.
5. **Ask anything.** The private, vetted Q&A and the four-questions toolkit; help is one tap away.
6. **Sticker.** The Decoder badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **feed-native "spot it" card** that looks real until the reveal pulls it apart, plus the **four-questions toolkit**. The verify-the-source habit and the reporting routes carry forward into Decoded (g36) and the adult media nodes; the body-image protection links back to Body Confident (g21).

Critical, calm, never explicit.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, real and matter-of-fact; sharp and a little mischievous, never lecturing.
- **Never explicit.** The media-and-sexuality module teaches literacy about media and never shows or describes any content.
- **Gated & disableable.** The sensitive module sits behind the school-comfort toggle and can be fully turned off; the media-literacy core remains.
- **No shame.** A teen who has seen something is never shamed; the focus is understanding and protection.
- **Reporting built in.** Clear routes for fakes and non-consensual or child imagery, cybercrime.gov.in / 1930, Childline 1098, a trusted adult, always one tap away. Never forward it.
- **Distress-aware Q&A.** Anonymous questions are vetted; any disclosure of exposure, exploitation or non-consensual imagery is routed urgently to safeguarding (POCSO / IT-Act aware), not just answered.
- **Access.** Audio available, offline, low-end build; India-grounded (viral forwards, deepfakes, the cyber portal); models the privacy it teaches.

Report, protect, never forward (India). A fake or non-consensual image: cybercrime.gov.in / 1930. Anyone under 18 at risk: Childline 1098. Anything that scares you: a trusted adult. Non-consensual and child imagery is a serious crime (POCSO Act, BNS, IT Rules), and India's portal mandates fast takedown, so reporting works.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. reality-check** — `node.game === GameDone key === registry id` (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. `type + typed payload`; the **spot/swipe** decode leads, with **strike-rewrite** for the myths.
- **Comfort-gated module**. The "media & sex" category honours the school-comfort toggle, and is fully disableable, server-side; never bundled into the core.
- **Fact-checked content**. Porn-literacy evidence, the deepfake "verify the source" standard, and the India reporting law/helplines verified; flag any legal/helpline edit for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (8 mechanics, spot at 19%, 0% binary, 17 autonomy, 15 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Reporting via the shared "get help" component (cybercrime portal / 1930 / Childline 1098 / trusted adult).
- **Tracked**. `sync_master_tracker.py` marks g28 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): critical & calm; never explicit; the sensitive module gated and disableable; no shame; reporting built in; verify the source; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Naming the trick is what disarms it.** Because manipulation works by hiding, making feeds' curation and the specific tactics visible is the proven core of media literacy, once a teen can see the trick, it stops fooling them.
- **Silence leaves porn as the teacher.** Since most teens encounter pornography well before 18, an honest, non-explicit literacy module, porn is performance, not real, not sex-ed, protects them where silence would not; it is gated so families and schools set the depth.
- **Against AI fakes, source-checking beats eyeballing.** Because the fakes-vs-detectors arms race makes visual tells unreliable, teaching teens to verify the source (reverse-search, provenance, reliable outlets) is the durable, future-proof skill.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 7 (media literacy & sexuality, incl. pornography) and UNESCO media & information literacy; pornography-literacy curricula (Rothman; Frontiers in Education, 2025) and exposure data (~93% boys / 62% girls before 18); deepfake-detection guidance (MIT Media Lab Detect Fakes; ESET; GIJN) on the verify-the-source standard; Government of India National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (cybercrime.gov.in / 1930), Childline 1098, and the POCSO Act / BNS / IT Rules on non-consensual and child imagery. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 32 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Capstone — Reading Relationships (c4).